

Keeping debt under control, like most things, is much easier when you make a habit of it. Even for people who consider themselves 'good with money', it's very easy to overspend on a credit card, because it's one step removed from your everyday finances. There's often a delay in the payment being visible on your account, it won't immediately affect your current account budget and you get to experience the pleasure of buying something without also experiencing the pain of paying for it right away. There's a disconnect between our spending behaviour and the financial consequences, which can really distort our ideas about what we can afford to spend, and leave us spiralling into financial difficulty if we're not careful.

Successfully managing debt and credit accounts is, in theory, very simple, but it can be harder in practice, when life and emotions get in the way. There's still a lot of stigma attached to most kinds of debt that can make it more difficult for us to engage with our debt in a positive and proactive way. The more we want to sweep it under the carpet, the more afraid we are to look at it head-on, the harder we make it to develop good habits around it. I really hope that completing Step Two, and doing some work around the relationship between your finances and your self-worth, will have made this a bit easier. The more we can remove emotions from decisions about credit and debt, the easier it is for us to manage them in a healthy way, because we're not bouncing from one knee-jerk reaction to another like a pinball. I know first-hand the effect that having debt can have on your mindset, and it's easy to